

from the window you are currently working on. It allows you to preview the contents of open windows by blacking out everything else so that you can switch to the one you want.

When you highlight the thumbnail preview of an app window that you might want open, it makes every other open window transparent, so you get a clear view of the window you're looking at. Or, if you hover over a small button on the bottom right corner of the taskbar, all open windows will fade from view, for a quick peek at your desktop, gadgets, or Windows 7's free-floating widgets.

4.4 Aero Shake

You can use Aero Shake to quickly minimize every open window except the one you're shaking. It is a useless-but-neat feature that clears all the clutter for you without you having to minimize each and every window apart from the one you want to focus on. It is just a mouse gesture that lets you grab the title bar of the window you wish to keep open and give it a shake, and enjoy in a clear desktop area. Of course, you can use Win+ Home key for the same functionality. It just adds that Zing to the new UI. You can even restore all of those windows by shaking the open window again.

4.5 Aero Snap

This is probably one of the most under hyped features of Windows 7. It makes life so much simpler especially if you have a widescreen monitor or a multi monitor setup. Just grab a window and throw it (not literally) to the top to maximize it. Pull it down and it will restore to original size again. Drag it to one side and it will tile to fill half the screen real estate. Dragging it to another monitor also becomes easy as it does not lose its state. It is very intuitive and soon becomes second nature when comparing two documents, copying or moving files between two windows, maximizing the window you're currently working on, or expanding long documents so they're easier to read and require less scrolling. On tablets, you can just swish your finger to the top to maximize. Probably not all that usefull but an indication of the things to come in future UIs.

Just in case you find this feature distracting, remember that it can be easily disabled. Run REGEDIT from the Run Command dialog box, go to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop, set WindowArrangementActive to 0, and reboot. Now your windows will behave just as they always did.